AUTO SPECIAL

INSIDER INSIGHTS



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FRESH CHALLENGES

THE NEW FINANCIAL YEAR BRINGS WITH IT A HOST OF NEW CHALLENGES, INCLUDING NEW SAFETY REGULATIONS AND THE PRESSURE TO MOVE AWAY FROM FOSSIL FUELS. WE ASK SOME INDUSTRY LEADERS HOW THEY ARE COPING

Q. WITH THE ONSET OF THE NEW FISCAL, HOW ARE YOU DEALING WITH THE INFLUX OF BOOKINGS AND THE LONG WAITING PERIODS?

• ASHISH GUPTA
Over the last few months, the supply chain situation has eased out, enabling us to deliver the preferred vehicles to customers within a reasonable time frame. However, supply chain constraints on specific components continue, though the frequency and scale have reduced. Overall, Volkswagen is maintaining the required momentum across all dealerships.

• JYOTI MALHOTRA
Volvo Cars India recorded an impressive 38 per cent growth in the first quarter of 2023 and the momentum is still growing for both BEV and ICE segment. Our Pure Electric car, XC40 Recharge, is getting a very good response. Currently we have a lead time of 3-4 months.

• TARUN GARG
As the leading smart mobility solutions provider in India, Hyundai continues to receive a very strong and positive customer response for our leading brands such as Ioniq 5, Creta, Venue, the all-new Hyundai Verna and Tucson, Aura and Grand i10 Nios among others. To ensure deliveries are made in the shortest possible time, we are continuously optimising our production to meet the demand.

• SANTOSH IYER
Mercedes-Benz sales in the Q1 of CY23 were the best for any Q1. We are striving to reduce the waiting period due to a very high demand. We have ramped up the production and added the second shift. Our priority remains to deliver the cars to the customers at the earliest.

Q. HOW DO YOU SEE THE NEW SAFETY REGULATIONS AFFECTING VEHICLE PRICES?

• ASHISH GUPTA
The revised safety norms in India are a step in the right direction for reducing fatalities and injuries. We at Volkswagen, believe in zero compromise on safety and are complying with the regulations while keeping the impact on vehicle prices to the minimum possible level.

• JYOTI MALHOTRA
The safety features incorporated in Volvo Cars are global benchmarks. If some specific changes need to be done, then we may have to adjust our prices accordingly.

Q. WHILE ELECTRIFICATION IS ON IN A BIG WAY, WHAT WILL BE THE ROLE OF ALTERNATIVE FUELS?

• ASHISH GUPTA
At Volkswagen, we offer a multitude of powertrain options globally—from petrol to hybrids and BEVs. In India, we are offering gasoline-based carlines with latest tech for substantial savings in fuel consumption and reduction in emissions without losing power and performance.

• JYOTI MALHOTRA
By 2030, Volvo Cars wants to offer only pure electric vehicles and phase out all internal combustion engine vehicles, including hybrids.